Cheng Chen

Prospective PhD Applicant

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Major rank 3/87
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Summary

- EE undergrad at Tongji (rank **3/87**). Research on **multimodal AI** and **trustworthy AI**.
- Looking for PhD opportunities in these areas.
- Accepted papers at **IJCAI**, **IJCNN**, **ICANN**, **ACM MM** (2 oral); submission to **NeurIPS**.

Education

B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering, Tongji University, Shanghai — 2023.09 – Present
Major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.

Research

OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment — IJCAI 2026
C. Chen*, Y. Xu*, M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Distill multiple clinical models into one small model without inheriting each teacher's bias.

If You Hear It, Help Find It: Orthogonal Knowledge Distillation for Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization — ACM MM 2026
Y. Xu*, **C. Chen***, W. Lei. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Open-vocabulary audio-visual event localization with orthogonal knowledge distillation.

Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Describe scenes in symbols so text-only LLMs can reason about images.

Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Plan retrieval under a fixed budget, including evidence that might disagree.

Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage — NeurIPS 2026
C. Chen et al. **Under review; first author.**
Flag risky neural-operator outputs in one forward pass.

Awards

Provincial First Prize, China Robot and Artificial Intelligence Competition	2026
National 2nd Prize, Global Campus AI Algorithm Elite Competition	2025
National 3rd Prize, Embedded Chip & System Design Competition, FPGA track	2025
Shanghai 3rd Prize, National Mathematical Modeling Competition	2025
Shanghai 3rd Prize, National Statistical Modeling Competition	2025
Provincial 2nd Prize, National College Student Mathematics Competition (CMC)	2024, 2025
Tongji University Outstanding Student Scholarship	2023–2024, 2024–2025

Skills

- **Experience:** Familiar with common research workflows and tools, including **Python**, **PyTorch**, **Git**, **LaTeX**, experiment tracking, and LLM/agent prototyping for literature review, coding, and analysis.
- **Writing:** English level sufficient to read and understand research papers; familiar with the focus, process, and logic of both academic writing and project writing.
- **Passion:** Genuinely enthusiastic about learning and exploration, and eager to push into areas I have not worked in yet.
- **Outside lab:** Football (Barça & Arsenal), cycling, music.